

Volcanic eruptions

A volcano erupts when molten rock called magma rises through the crust and escapes as lava, ash and volcanic gas. Explosive eruptions happen when gas-rich magma fragments violently, throwing ash high into the sky.

Earthquakes and fault lines

Earthquakes release stress stored along faults where tectonic plates grind past each other. Seismometers record the shaking, and the magnitude scale measures the energy released by the rupture.